

Duke alumni messages

For Amaris to send through the Duke alumni directory · 74 alumni · built 2026-10-06

- **Box 2 (introduce yourself)** is the same for everyone apart from the first name. It's shown once below; the CSV has it filled in per person.
- **Box 3 (why them)** is written per person from facts verified in the investor list. Check each one before sending.
- **Tone:** Duke's terms of use bar unsolicited commercial solicitation on its sites, so each message asks for advice and introductions, with the traction as context. Send in small batches, highest fit first, and follow up only once.

Box 2: Introduce yourself (same for all)

Hi [first name],

I'm Amaris, a current Duke undergrad and co-founder and COO of SimReal (simreal.co), a neolab building data infra, RL environments and recursive self-improvement (RSI) for future AI. I did data science at Millennium as a summer intern and have a full-time offer. My co-founders are Charles (CEO; LSE Maths, Citadel, employee #1 at \$1.5B+ stablecoin unicorn United Stables) and Henry (CTO; Cambridge Maths, ex-Jane Street). We're 3 weeks old and at \$7M ARR from agent and expert data orders we're already delivering.

High fit · 12

1 Cassie Young

General Partner · Primary Venture Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Your Primary page says you're looking for founders in fintech and enterprise AI, and you lead seed rounds there. That's where we sit: we sell agent and expert data to AI labs, and our trading product Xitadel, built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making. Could I get 15 minutes of your advice on our seed round, or a sense of whether it fits Primary? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

2 David Beisel

Co-founder & Partner · NextView Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

NextView, the seed firm you co-founded after studying economics at Duke, backed Skyfall AI's continual reinforcement learning platform in a July seed round. That deal sits right next to our work: SimReal builds RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI, and Xitadel, our first trading product, has reached a verifiable level of RSI. Would 15 minutes work for your advice on our seed round, or a quick read on whether it could fit NextView? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Same fund as Rob Go (rank 20); pick one person per fund. Beisel's Skyfall AI angle is the closer fit.

3 Jake Flomenberg

Partner · Wing Venture Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You took a Duke triple major in ECE, computer science and economics, and this year you co-led Gray Swan AI's \$40M Series A at Wing. Our work sits next to that: we deliver agent and expert data for AI labs, and those orders took us to \$7M ARR in our first 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Wing? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Gray Swan (his 2026 deal) is listed as an RL environment vendor, so keep SimReal framed as complementary, not a competitor.

4 **Logan Allin**

Founder & Managing Partner · Fin Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Fin Capital names enterprise AI and wealth and capital markets among its focus areas, and you've stayed close to Duke through the FinTech advisory board. That's our overlap: Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, is built with IMC's data and significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading abilities. Could you spare 15 minutes to advise us on our seed round, or tell us whether it might fit Fin Capital? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

5 **Mark Kraynak**

Founding Partner · Acrew Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You paired electrical engineering and English at Duke Pratt, and in March you spoke for Acrew when it led Reclaim Security's \$20M Series A. Data is the common thread with us: SimReal builds data infrastructure for AI and reached \$7M ARR in 3 weeks from agent and expert data orders. Would you have 15 minutes for advice on our seed round, or a view on whether it fits Acrew? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Fund already in the SimReal pipeline via Asad Khaliq (Acrew Capital); pick one person per fund.

6 Naveen Rao

Angel investor; Co-founder & CEO, Unconventional AI · Angel investor

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Between your EECS degree at Duke, co-founding MosaicML and your angel check into Cleanlab's seed, training infrastructure and data quality are home turf for you. We build RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI, and our first trading product, Xitadel, has reached a verifiable level of RSI. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and would you consider a small angel check? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Founder-CEO (Unconventional AI) and angel; keep the ask light.

7 Steve Pagliuca

Founder & CEO · PagsGroup

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You serve on Duke's Board of Trustees, and through PagsGroup you co-led the seed round of Liquid AI, an MIT spinoff building new foundation models. We're a 3-week-old neolab building RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI, and agent and expert data orders already have us at \$7M ARR. I'd value 15 minutes of your advice on our seed round, including whether it could fit PagsGroup. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: PagsGroup writes large, growth-leaning checks; a seed round may sit below its usual size.

8 Wes Barton

Co-founder & General Partner · Third Prime

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You co-founded Third Prime after Duke Law, and your team just co-led Limited's \$18.5M seed in crypto-and-fiat banking. We're building the AI side of that world: Xitadel, our trading RSI product built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Third Prime? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

9 Zach Perret

Co-founder, Mischief; Co-founder & CEO, Plaid · Mischief

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You studied physics and chemistry at Duke, co-founded Plaid, and still write angel checks, including into Lassie's Series A in June. We're three 21-year-old undergrads with backgrounds at Citadel, Jane Street and Millennium, and we shipped 7 products in SimReal's first 2 weeks. Could I get 15 minutes of your advice on our seed round, and ask whether you'd consider a small angel check? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Founder-CEO; keep the ask light. Lauren Farleigh runs Mischief's investing day to day, so this asks for a personal angel check.

10 Howie Liu

Angel investor; Co-founder & CEO, Airtable · Angel investor

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Your angel checks into Fireworks AI and Decagon, plus Airtable's launch of Superagent this year, put you close to the AI agent stack. Agent data is a core part of our business: agent and expert data orders took SimReal to \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. As a fellow Blue Devil, would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and would you consider a small angel check? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Founder-CEO (Airtable) and angel; keep the ask light.

11 Kevin King

Co-founder & General Partner · 53 Stations

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You studied math and economics at Duke, worked at Goldman Sachs and Windhorse Capital, and now invest across fintech and AI at 53 Stations. Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, sits in that overlap: built with IMC's data, it significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading abilities. If you have 15 minutes, I'd welcome your advice on our seed round and your view on whether 53 Stations might be a fit. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: His Duke class year ('06) is not fully confirmed, so the message leaves it out.

12 Mark Peter Davis

Managing Partner · Interplay

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Networking ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Founding the Duke Venture Community makes you a natural first call for a Duke founder, and Interplay backs fintech and AI companies at seed and Series A, including Knot. SimReal is 3 weeks old and already at \$7M ARR from the agent and expert data orders we're delivering. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Interplay? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Medium fit · 30

13 Danny Hadar

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Jibe Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

From your Fuqua MBA to angel checks in companies like Snyk to co-founding Jibe, which led Fabrix Security's \$8M seed in 2025, you've spent years at the earliest stage. SimReal, a neolab building RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI, reached \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. I know Jibe backs Israeli founders, so I'd mainly value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and any investors you'd suggest we meet. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Jibe backs Israeli founders and SimReal is not an Israeli team, so the ask is advice and introductions, not a Jibe check.

14 Greg Baker

Executive Partner · Alumni Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Networking ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You earned your MBA at Fuqua and now run Towerview Ventures, Alumni Ventures' fund for Duke-connected companies, and SimReal is Duke-connected through me, its COO. We're a 3-week-old neolab building data infrastructure and RL environments for future AI, already at \$7M ARR from agent and expert data orders. Could you spare 15 minutes to tell us how SimReal should apply or be considered for Towerview as we raise our seed? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Towerview co-invests alongside a lead VC, so SimReal will need a lead investor first.

15 Gregg Bordes

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Front Porch Venture Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Front Porch grew out of your Fuqua MBA class, where you met your co-founders, and the firm now backs Southeast fintech and enterprise software. On the fintech side, Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, is built with IMC's data and significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading abilities. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Front Porch? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Same fund as Joe Mancini (rank 17); pick one person per fund. Front Porch invests directly only in Southeast startups.

16 Howard Lerman

Angel investor; Founder & CEO, Roam · Angel investor

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

After studying history at Duke, you co-founded Yext, now run Roam, and joined Orchard Robotics' \$22M Series A as an angel in September 2025. We're three 21-year-old undergrads, and SimReal shipped 7 products in its first 2 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes for advice on our seed round, and would you consider a small angel check? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Founder-CEO (Roam) and angel; keep the ask light.

17 Joe Mancini

Co-founder & General Partner · Front Porch Venture Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Front Porch's Founder Pulse Survey in September asked Southeast founders about AI and the capital environment, and you co-founded the firm with two classmates from your Fuqua Daytime MBA. Here's one AI data point for that picture: SimReal is 3 weeks old and at \$7M ARR from agent and expert data orders. Could I get 15 minutes of your advice on our seed round, and a sense of whether Front Porch could be a fit? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Same fund as Gregg Bordes (rank 15); pick one person per fund. The record suggests Mancini as the tech-side partner. Front Porch invests directly only in Southeast startups.

18 Katelyn Donnelly

Founder & Managing Partner · Avalanche VC

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Your Duke economics honors thesis was on time-zone arbitrage in Vanguard international index funds, and Avalanche now invests in how people learn, earn and own. Trading links us too: Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, is built with IMC's data and significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Avalanche? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

19 Marc Andrusko

Partner · Oak HC/FT

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You studied public policy and markets and management at Duke, worked in interest rate sales and trading at Goldman, and now list capital markets as a thesis area at Oak HC/FT. Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, is built with IMC's data and has reached a verifiable level of RSI in trading. Would 15 minutes work for your advice on our seed round, or a view on whether Oak HC/FT ever invests this early? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Oak HC/FT invests at early and growth stages; seed is less typical.

20 Rob Go

Co-founder & Partner · NextView Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You co-founded NextView after a Duke economics degree and time at Spark Capital, and its seed focus includes both fintech and AI. In our first 3 weeks, SimReal reached \$7M ARR from agent and expert data orders. Could you spare 15 minutes to advise us on our seed round, or tell us whether it might fit NextView? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Same fund as David Beisel (rank 2); pick one person per fund. Beisel's Skyfall AI angle is the closer fit.

21 Thomas D. Lehrman

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Teamworthy Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

After Duke, Yale Law and Tiger Management, you co-founded GLG, the expert network, and now back founders from pre-seed onward at Teamworthy. Expert knowledge is central to us as well: expert data and agent data orders have taken SimReal to \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Teamworthy? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

22 W. Bradford (Brad) Stephens

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Blockchain Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

After studying economics at Duke, you co-founded Blockchain Capital with your brother Bart, and the firm has backed Coinbase, Circle and Tether. Our overlap is trading: Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, is built with IMC's data and significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading abilities. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether trading-focused AI could ever fit Blockchain Capital? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Blockchain Capital is crypto-only and no AI deals were found; expect advice rather than a check.

23 Will Bumpus

Partner · Westbound Equity Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You went from Duke to M&A at Perella Weinberg, then to Headspace, and now back early-stage founders at Westbound, which closed its \$100M Fund II in 2024. Our early traction: 3 weeks in, SimReal is at \$7M ARR from agent and expert data orders. Could I ask for 15 minutes of advice on our seed round, and your view on whether it could fit Westbound? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Westbound backs underrepresented founders; his own sector interests may be sustainability, food tech and education rather than finance.

24 Blake Byers

Founder · Byers Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

At GV you backed Robinhood early, years after studying biomedical engineering and economics at Duke. That makes trading our natural link: Xitadel, our trading RSI product built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading abilities. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Byers Capital? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Byers Capital mostly invests at Series A and B; seed appetite is unverified.

25 David Cummings

Founder & CEO · Atlanta Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You started Hannon Hill while still a Duke student, went on to co-found Pardot, and were the lead investor in Calendly. We're student founders too: three 21-year-old undergrads who shipped 7 products in SimReal's first 2 weeks. Since Atlanta Ventures focuses on the Southeast, would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and would you consider a small angel check? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Founder-CEO of Atlanta Ventures, which focuses on Atlanta and the Southeast; a personal angel check is the realistic ask.

26 Deb Liu

Co-founder & angel investor · Ember AI

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Networking ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You went from civil engineering at Pratt, as a B.N. Duke Scholar, to creating Facebook Marketplace, and now you're co-founding Ember AI and writing angel checks into seed rounds like Keebler Health's. As fellow founders, we've been building fast: SimReal shipped 7 products in its first 2 weeks and reached \$7M ARR in 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and say whether you'd consider a small angel check? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Full-time co-founder of Ember AI and an angel; keep the ask light. Duke Capital Partners Investor Member.

27 Jason Fernandez

General Partner · Creci Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

As a Fuqua Alumni Council member, you spent 20 years in financial services before backing B2B and financial software at Creci Ventures. SimReal is 3 weeks old and already at \$7M ARR, from agent data and expert data orders we're delivering now. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Creci or Quake Capital? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

28 Jeremy Levine

Partner · Bessemer Venture Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

When Bessemer closed \$1.75B for seed and early-stage companies last month, you said the firm wants to back founders before the market fully recognizes the opportunity. We think recursive self-improvement is that kind of opportunity: Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, built with IMC's data, has reached a verifiable level of RSI in trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it fits Bessemer's early-stage fund? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Bessemer is already in the SimReal pipeline via Janelle Teng Wade; pick one person per fund. He may lean growth-stage.

29 Kent Ho

Founder & General Partner · S28 Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

After Duke economics and Goldman Sachs, you backed Palantir and Zoom early through Harbor Pacific, and S28 now invests at seed and Series A in enterprise infrastructure. We're building that layer for AI: data infrastructure and RL environments, with agent data and expert data orders already being delivered. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit S28? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: No S28 deals seen in 2026 (latest Sep-Nov 2025).

30 **Lawson DeVries**

Managing General Partner · Grotech Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Grotech joined Sturdy.ai's \$6M seed in April 2025, and as a Fuqua MBA you've led the firm as Managing General Partner since 2020. Our business is the data underneath AI products like that: we deliver agent data and expert data, which took SimReal to \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Grotech? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Grotech backs companies outside Silicon Valley; confirm SimReal's location fits that mandate.

31 **Mengxi Lu**

Angel investor; Co-founder & CEO, Kanmon · Angel investor

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Your angel thesis covers fintech, data infrastructure and AI, and you've backed fintech infrastructure like Moov and Salsa while building Kanmon. Xitadel sits where those meet: our first trading RSI product, built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-72B's market making and trading abilities. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and would you consider a small angel check? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Founder-CEO (Kanmon) and angel with \$5K-\$50K checks; keep the ask light.

32 Robert Ravanshenas

Investment Partner · Maven Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

As a fellow Blue Devil, you backed Validity, a startup founded by Duke FinTech master's students, and your own focus at Maven is AI and fintech. Our first product brings those together: Xitadel, a trading RSI product built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and point us to AI or fintech investors you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Maven's mandate is consumer software at seed, so the ask is advice and intros. Jim Scheinman (rank 49) is also at Maven; contact one person per fund.

33 Scott Raney

Managing Director · Redpoint Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You joined Duke's Board of Trustees this July, after 26 years backing cloud infrastructure and open-source software at Redpoint. We're building infrastructure for the next stage of AI: RL environments and recursive self-improvement, and our first trading RSI product, Xitadel, has reached a verifiable level of RSI in trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Redpoint? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Redpoint is already in the SimReal pipeline via Jordan Segall; pick one person per fund. He may now sit on Redpoint's growth side.

34 **Sergey Khusnetdinov**

Founder & Managing Partner · Ga³in Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Networking ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

A Fuqua Cross Continent MBA who now co-presides over DukeGEN, you also founded Ga³in Ventures, whose Ga³in Early program makes selective pre-seed and seed investments in AI and frontier tech. That's where SimReal sits: we're a neolab building data infrastructure, RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Ga³in Early? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

35 **Shaan Puri**

Founder & GP; angel investor; co-host, My First Million · Shaan's All Access Fund

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Alongside My First Million and your All Access Fund, you've backed AI tools as an angel, including Gumloop's \$17M Series A. Our pace may interest you: SimReal is 3 weeks old, at \$7M ARR, and shipped 7 products in its first 2 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and say whether a small angel check or the fund could fit? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Generalist angel with a consumer and health tilt; keep the ask light.

36 William Crowder

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Aperture Venture Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Since 2024 you've taught venture capital to Fuqua MBAs, and Aperture backs technology that improves the movement and security of capital. Our team comes from trading: Charles interned on Citadel's fixed income trading desk, Henry is ex-Jane Street, and our first product, Xitadel, is a trading RSI product built with IMC's data. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Aperture? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Aperture prioritizes Black, Latin and female founders; fit is uncertain.

37 Amit Mehra

General Partner · Borderless Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You manage Web3 investments at Borderless, which joined NeuraMint's \$5M AI-agent seed in January 2026, and you're a Fuqua MBA and CFA charterholder. Our first product sits where finance and AI meet: Xitadel, a trading RSI product built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Borderless? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: His 2026 role at Borderless is unconfirmed.

38 Ashley Flucas

Founder & General Partner · Flucas Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Your Flucas Ventures syndicate has backed Databricks, Brex and Mercury, and you studied political science at Duke before Harvard Law. SimReal is data infrastructure for AI: we deliver agent data and expert data, and those orders took us to \$7M ARR in our first 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit your syndicate? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: She is also full-time COO and General Counsel at Summit Ventures; no 2026 syndicate deal verified.

39 Jason Freedman

General Partner · Peak State Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Peak State joined Hamming AI's \$3.8M seed for testing AI voice agents, and you once ran FlightCaster, a machine-learning company from an early Y Combinator batch. We work near that layer, building RL environments and agent data for AI, and a Managing Partner at Y Combinator has already reached out with interest. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Peak State? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: His title varies across sources (General Partner vs. Venture Partner), and no 2026 deals were found.

40 Pamir Gelenbe

Founder & Managing Partner · Libertus Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Before founding Libertus, you worked at D.E. Shaw and Morgan Stanley and invested in trading venues like Kraken and Crypto Facilities. Xitadel should speak to that background: our first trading RSI product, built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and has reached a verifiable level of RSI in trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Libertus? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Libertus is a crypto/Web3 fund with no deal found after March 2025.

41 Padowithz "Pad" Alce

Angel investor; Founding Partner, AI Patent Law · Angel investor, Duke Capital Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Networking ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You founded AI Patent Law after your Duke Law LLM in Law & Entrepreneurship, and you now invest through Duke Capital Partners and lecture at Duke. We're a Duke-linked team building RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI, and SimReal shipped 7 products in its first 2 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round and on how SimReal should approach Duke Capital Partners? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

42 Lisa Burton O'Toole

Executive Director · HearstLab

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

After Pratt and an MIT PhD, you took AdMass through HearstLab's program before joining HearstLab to invest in women-led data and technology startups. I'm SimReal's COO and one of three founders; we deliver agent data and expert data for AI, and reached \$7M ARR in our first 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, and tell us whether a team like ours could fit HearstLab? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: HearstLab funds only women-led startups; Amaris is COO, not CEO, so eligibility is doubtful. Treat this as advice-first.

Low fit · 29

43 Adam Besvinick

Founder & Managing Partner · Looking Glass Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You founded Looking Glass to be the first yes for mission-driven founders, and you co-led Simuhealth's \$2.62M pre-seed last December. We're outside your health and climate focus: SimReal builds RL environments and expert data for AI, and reached \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, an intro to an AI or fintech investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

44 Ali Behbahani

Partner & Co-Head of Healthcare · NEA

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You studied biomedical engineering, electrical engineering and chemistry at Duke, and you've co-headed NEA's healthcare practice, with board seats including CRISPR Therapeutics. Our work is far from biopharma: we're a neolab building data infrastructure and RL environments for future AI, and we shipped 7 products in our first 2 weeks. Could I have 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, an intro to an AI investor you trust at NEA or elsewhere? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

45 Dan Levitan

Co-founder & General Partner · Maveron

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You graduated from Duke in 1979 and co-founded Maveron with Howard Schultz; the firm's 2026 consumer investments include Wonderdog and Kin Health. SimReal is far from consumer: we build data infrastructure and RL environments for AI, and reached \$7M ARR in our first 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, introduce us to an AI or fintech investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

46 Doug Brown

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Dental Innovation Alliance

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

With a Duke BS and a Fuqua MBA, you co-founded Dental Innovation Alliance, which backed dental-AI company Relu from its seed through its August Series A. Specialist AI depends on expert data, which is what we deliver: expert data and agent data orders took SimReal to \$7M ARR in 3 weeks. Could I have 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, an intro to an AI investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

47 Gonzalo Costa

Co-founder & General Partner · NXTP Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

At Fuqua you co-founded the Latin American Student Association, and NXTP, which you co-founded in 2011, led AI startup Luzid's \$2.8M pre-seed and backed Auth0 early. We're outside NXTP's Latin American mandate but close to its B2B and AI thesis: SimReal builds data infrastructure and RL environments, and reached \$7M ARR in 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round and introduce us to an AI or fintech investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

48 Jeff Terrell

Managing Partner · Arboretum Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

After a Fuqua MBA focused on health care and finance, you spent 13 years at Hatteras Venture Partners in Durham before joining Arboretum, where you're now Managing Partner. Our work is outside medtech: SimReal builds RL environments and expert data for AI, and shipped 7 products in its first 2 weeks. Could I have 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, an intro to an AI or fintech investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

49 Jim Scheinman

Founding Managing Partner · Maven Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

A Trinity '88 grad, you were an early investor in Zoom, and Maven's \$60M Fund IV puts a heavy emphasis on consumer AI. We sit a layer below consumer products, building data infrastructure, RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI, and we reached \$7M ARR in 3 weeks. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, an intro to an AI investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Robert Ravanshenas (rank 32) is also at Maven; contact one person per fund.

50 John Tough

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Energize Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You co-founded Energize, which led Nixtla's \$16M Series A in February 2026 for time-series foundation models. We're outside your climate mandate but close to that modeling problem: Xitadel, our first trading RSI product, built with IMC's data, significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, an intro to an AI or fintech investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

51 Kathryn Minshew

Operating Partner & Angel investor · XFactor Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You co-founded The Muse after Duke ('08) and now advise a Fortune 100 company on change management in the age of AI. We work on the other side of that shift: SimReal sells agent and expert data to AI labs and reached \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. Since that's outside your usual focus, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

52 Kerry Rupp

General Partner · True Wealth Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Since 2016 you've been a general partner at True Wealth Ventures, backing women-led seed companies in human and environmental health, and you studied biology at Duke ('93). We're far from that thesis: SimReal is a 3-week-old company building RL environments and data infrastructure for AI, already at \$7M ARR. Given your years running the DreamIt accelerator, could I get 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

53 Lindy Morris Fishburne

Founding Managing Partner · Breakout Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Breakout's \$114M Fund III backs startups 'unlocking the complexity of science with AI,' and you co-founded the firm after Duke ('92) and Breakout Labs. We sit lower in the AI stack: SimReal builds RL environments and data infrastructure, and our trading product, Xitadel, has reached a verifiable level of recursive self-improvement. Since we're outside your science thesis, could I get 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI-infrastructure investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

54 Lisa Blau

Founding Partner · Able Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Since graduating from Duke in '97, you've co-founded Vital Juice and Able Partners, whose health and wellness portfolio now includes DUOS, an AI benefits platform for seniors. We work a layer beneath AI products like that, on data infrastructure and RL environments, and SimReal reached \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. Since consumer health is your focus, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

55 Namita Thapar

Shark Tank India investor; Executive Director, Emcure Pharmaceuticals · Angel investor

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You've backed more than 100 startups, including the AI-native wearable NeoSapien on Shark Tank India, and you earned your MBA at Fuqua in 2001. SimReal moves quickly: we're 3 weeks old and already at \$7M ARR from the agent and expert data orders we're delivering to AI labs. As this is outside your usual sectors, would you have 15 minutes for advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI or fintech investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

56 Paul Straub

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Wireframe Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

A Fuqua MBA ('05), you led Wireframe's investment in OpenInvest, the impact-investing fintech that JPMorgan later acquired. That deal sits closest to our work: Xitadel, our first trading product, is built with IMC's data and significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. Since we're outside Wireframe's climate and health thesis, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to a fintech or AI investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

57 Sydney Thomas

Founder & General Partner · Symphonic Capital

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You studied public policy at Duke ('10), helped scale Precursor Ventures to more than 400 investments, and closed Symphonic Capital's \$13.5M pre-seed Fund I in 2025. We're at the earliest stage too: SimReal is 3 weeks old and shipped 7 products in its first 2 weeks. Since B2B AI sits outside Symphonic's thesis, could I get 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to a pre-seed AI or fintech investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

58 Todd Pietri

Co-founder & Co-Managing Partner · Activate Venture Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

As a Duke English grad who co-founded Milestone Venture Partners in 1999, you've guided more than a dozen portfolio companies to exits, including software and data businesses. SimReal builds data infrastructure for AI, and three weeks in we're at \$7M ARR from the agent and expert data orders we're delivering. Since Activate's recent deals are in digital health, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI-infrastructure investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

59 Carmichael Roberts

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Material Impact

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

With a BS and PhD in organic chemistry from Duke, you co-founded Material Impact and now co-lead the investment committee at Breakthrough Energy Ventures. We move on a different clock from materials and energy: SimReal shipped 7 products in its first 2 weeks, building RL environments and data infrastructure for AI. Since that's outside your mandate, would you have 15 minutes for advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

60 David Lamond

Managing Partner · Lamond Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Your family's 2026 gift to Duke backs advanced computing and AI-driven hardware, and you sit on the Pratt Board of Visitors (Trinity '97, Law '06). SimReal works one layer up, in software: we build RL environments for AI and reached \$7M ARR in our first 3 weeks. Since your portfolio leans toward biotech and medtech, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

61 John Glushik

Managing Director · HG Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Networking ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You were the founding director of the Duke Angel Network, and HG Ventures, where you're a Managing Director, backed Duality Robotics' \$12M Series A for ML-training simulation environments. We build RL environments for language models: our first trading product, Xitadel, is built with IMC's data and significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. Would you have 15 minutes to advise on our seed round and point me to Duke angels or AI investors you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

62 Josh Felser

Co-founder & Managing Partner · Climactic

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You hold a Duke BA ('86) and a Fuqua MBA ('90), co-founded Freestyle Capital in 2008, and now back software-first climate companies at Climactic. We reached \$7M ARR in SimReal's first 3 weeks, from the agent and expert data orders we're delivering to AI labs. It's outside Climactic's climate mandate, so I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust.
calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

63 Lia Cromwell

Partner · UpWest

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

In CTech's 2026 VC Survey you pointed to the latent potential of vertical AI, and as a Duke '15 grad you now lead UpWest's Israel investment team. Xitadel is our vertical AI for trading: built with IMC's data, it significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. I know UpWest backs Israeli founders, so I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI or fintech investor you trust.
calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: UpWest invests only in Israeli founders; the ask is advice and intros, not UpWest.

64 Lori Cashman

Founder & General Partner · Visible Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Visible Ventures acquired dcdx in September to build 'a new kind of human intelligence company,' and you're a former chair of Duke's Public Policy Board of Visitors. Human expertise is our business too: SimReal reached \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks from expert and agent data orders. Could I get 15 minutes of your advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI or fintech investor you trust?
calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

65 Luis von Ahn

Angel investor; Co-founder & CEO, Duolingo · Angel investor

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

After a math degree at Duke ('00), you co-developed CAPTCHA with Manuel Blum at Carnegie Mellon, and you still make angel investments while running Duolingo. Two of our three founders are math undergrads too, and we shipped 7 products in SimReal's first 2 weeks, building data infrastructure and RL environments for AI. I'd value 15 minutes of your advice on our seed round, and an intro to an AI investor you trust if one comes to mind. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Founder-CEO; keep the ask light.

66 Nikin Shah

Co-founder & General Partner · Front Porch Venture Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You met your Front Porch co-founders in your Fuqua MBA class of '12, and you lead the firm's healthcare investing as Fund 3, opened in January, gets going. SimReal is outside healthcare entirely: we're a 3-week-old company building RL environments and data infrastructure for AI, already at \$7M ARR. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round and introduce me to an AI or fintech investor you trust? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Same firm as Joe Mancini (rank 17) and Gregg Bordes (rank 15); the record suggests contacting Mancini instead, so pick one person per fund.

67 Salman Azhar

General Partner · Azimuth Opportunity Fund

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You teach AI and financial systems at Fuqua, hold a Duke PhD in computer science ('94), and have co-founded more than 30 predictive-computing and analytics startups. That mix is our product: Xitadel, our first trading product, is built with IMC's data and significantly improves Qwen-3.8-27B's market making and trading. Since Azimuth buys pre-IPO shares, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and whether it might suit a personal angel check or someone you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Azimuth does late-stage secondaries; the ask targets his personal angel checks.

68 Squire Servance

Founder & Managing Partner · Syridex Bio

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Through Syridex Bio you backed Qunova, an AI-driven population-health platform, and you earned both your JD and MBA at Duke in 2008. We work on the data side of AI: three weeks in, SimReal is at \$7M ARR from the agent and expert data orders it's delivering to AI labs. Since Syridex focuses on life sciences, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust.
calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

69 Camille Samuels

Partner · Venrock

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

At Venrock you back early-stage biotech, devices and consumer health, often helping create seed-stage companies, and you studied biology at Duke ('93). SimReal sits outside healthcare: we build data infrastructure, RL environments and recursive self-improvement for future AI, and shipped 7 products in our first 2 weeks. I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round and, if it seems right, an intro to a Venrock colleague who covers AI. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: No dated 2026 source confirms she is still at Venrock.

70 Jared Weinstein

Founder · Overton

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

From Duke public policy ('02) to founding partner at Thrive Capital, you now make concentrated bets on high-conviction entrepreneurs through Overton. SimReal is 3 weeks old and at \$7M ARR, and a Managing Partner at Y Combinator has already reached out with interest. If you have 15 minutes, I'd value your advice on our seed round and an intro to an AI investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Overton's direct deals are Birmingham-focused and not public; the ask is advice and intros.

71 Melinda French Gates

Founder · Pivotal Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice and investor introductions for my startup"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

Before your Fuqua MBA you studied computer science and economics at Duke ('86), and this year Pivotal made a \$3M investment in Binti's AI-driven child-welfare software. SimReal works further down the AI stack, on data infrastructure and RL environments, and reached \$7M ARR in its first 3 weeks. Since this is outside Pivotal's mission, I'd value 15 minutes of advice on our seed round from you or your team, and an intro to an AI investor you trust. calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Very unlikely to reply to a cold note; Pivotal's investments are reportedly run day to day by a separate investor. Low priority.

Verify first (Duke year not public) · 3

M1 Nikhil Mittal

· BlueRidge Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

As a Fuqua alum at BlueRidge Ventures, you're part of a pre-seed AI fund that sources from Duke alumni and has stated conviction in fintech infrastructure. That's our overlap: Xitadel, our first trading product, is built with IMC's data and has reached a verifiable level of recursive self-improvement in trading. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit BlueRidge?
calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Verify Duke degree year in the directory first

M2 Kurt Schmidt

· Duke Capital Partners

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Networking ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

You attended Duke Law and now run Duke Capital Partners, the university's own early-stage fund for Duke-affiliated teams, and I'm a Duke student co-founding one. SimReal is 3 weeks old and already at \$7M ARR from the agent and expert data orders we're delivering. Could you spare 15 minutes to advise on our seed round and tell us how SimReal should apply or be considered for Duke Capital Partners?
calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Verify Duke degree year in the directory first

M3 Elle Leemay Chen

· Reciprocal Ventures

WHY ARE YOU CONTACTING THIS ALUM? (TICK)

Professional connections or referrals ; Other: "Advice on my startup's seed round"

BOX 3: EXPLAIN WHY YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO CONTACT THEM

As a Duke BA working with Reciprocal Ventures, a fintech and crypto fund, you sit close to the world our team comes from. Our CEO, Charles, was employee #1 at United Stables, a \$1.5B+ stablecoin unicorn, after a Citadel fixed income trading internship in London. Would you have 15 minutes to share advice on our seed round, or tell us whether it could fit Reciprocal? calendly.com/business-simreal/30min

Thank you,
Amaris

Note: Verify Duke degree year in the directory first